

Make Every Meeting Efficient Utilizing Microsoft Teams Features

Struggle with unproductive meetings? This guide shows you how to leverage Microsoft Teams features for efficient, focused discussions. Follow these steps and transform your meetings into productive sessions that achieve results!

Every meeting, regardless of whether it's a new or recurring one, requires a designated organizer. This organizer is responsible for implementing the following best practices to ensure efficient and productive meetings for all participants.

1.Title

- **Focus on Clarity and Conciseness:**
 - **Keep it short:** Aim for a title that's between 5-10 words.
 - **Use plain language:** Avoid jargon or acronyms that attendees might not understand.
 - **Highlight the purpose:** Clearly state the reason for the meeting.
- **Examples of Clear and Concise Titles:**
 - **Weekly Team Meeting** (General)
 - **Project X: Status Update** (Project-Specific)
 - **Brainstorming Session: Marketing Campaign** (Purpose-Oriented)
- **Emphasize Action or Outcome:**
 - **Consider what you want to achieve by the end of the meeting.**
 - **Use action verbs to indicate the desired outcome.**
- **Examples with Action/Outcome:**
 - **Finalize Budget for Q3** (Focuses on achieving a specific task)
 - **Decision-Making: Client Proposal** (Highlights a decision point)
 - **Review and Feedback: Sales Strategy** (Indicates discussion and feedback)
- **Additional Tips:**
 - **Consider the audience:** Tailor the title to be relevant to the attendees.
 - **Use keywords:** Include keywords that might help attendees find the meeting in a calendar search.
 - **Be specific, but not too specific:** Don't reveal too much detail in the title, but ensure it gives enough context.

- **Examples with Audience and Keywords:**

- **[Marketing Team] Content Calendar Planning** (Targets specific team and purpose)
- **[Urgent] Server Outage - Resolution Discussion** (Highlights urgency and topic)

By following these suggestions, you can set clear and informative meeting titles that effectively communicate the purpose of your meeting to attendees.

2. Description

A clear and concise description that provides essential details about the meeting beyond the title.

[Organizer Name] is inviting you to a meeting to discuss [Brief explanation of meeting purpose].

This format ensures the organizer's information is upfront and sets the context for the meeting with a concise explanation of the purpose.

3. Necessity of the Members

- **Consider Relevance:** When inviting participants, assess their relevance to the meeting's purpose. Avoid unnecessary attendees who won't actively contribute.
- **Dependency:** Understand dependencies between team members. Involve those whose input directly impacts the meeting's outcomes.

4. Agenda

Every meeting should have a well-defined agenda. Microsoft Teams provides a convenient way to create and share an agenda directly within the meeting invitation. This ensures everyone is on the same page and prepared to contribute.

- **Add an Agenda:** When scheduling a meeting in Microsoft Teams, locate the "Add an agenda" option within the meeting details section. Click on it to access the agenda creation tools. If it's a completed meeting, you will find "Add meeting notes" instead of "Add an agenda".
- **Structure Your Agenda:** Microsoft Teams provides three sections to organize your agenda effectively.

- **Agenda:** List the specific topics you plan to cover during the meeting. Use clear and concise titles to help participants come prepared to discuss each point. It's important to adhere to these discussion points during the meeting. New topics can be introduced, but only if they are a high priority and time will be initiated.
- **Meeting notes:** While discussing each topic, use the "Meeting Notes" section to capture any action items or decisions made. These notes also can be considered as Minutes of Meeting (MoM).
- **Follow-up tasks:** When creating tasks with "Follow-up tasks," leverage the built-in connection with Microsoft To-Do. This allows you to:
 - **Assign Tasks:** Clearly designate individuals responsible for completing each action item. The assigned tasks will automatically appear in their Microsoft To-Do list.
 - **Set Due Dates:** Establishing clear deadlines for tasks keeps everyone focused and facilitates timely completion.
 - **Bucket:** This is used to monitor the progress of each task status.
- **Recurring meeting:** When you create a new recurring meeting, the agenda will be copied to all future meetings. However, it can be edited, allowing you to set a different agenda for each meeting.

5. Meeting Frequency

- **Evaluate Importance:** Regularly assess the need for recurring meetings. If there are no critical points to discuss, consider adjusting the frequency (e.g., biweekly or monthly).
- **Quality Over Quantity:** Prioritize quality discussions over frequent but unproductive meetings.

6. Video Calls for Engagement

- **Guideline:** By default, all calls should be video calls.
- **Exception:** Participants may opt for audio-only calls in special cases, such as when they don't have sufficient internet connection for video calls. In such situations, it's courteous to inform participants that you cannot join via video for specific reasons
- **Benefits:**

- **Visual Connection:** Participants can see each other, fostering better engagement.
- **Nonverbal Cues:** Facial expressions and body language enhance communication.
- **Attention:** Video calls discourage multitasking.

7. Booking Meeting Rooms During Scheduling

- **Location Option:** When scheduling a meeting, use the “Add Location” option.
- **At Your Space:** If attending the call from your desk, leave the location blank.
- **Meeting Room Needed:** If the meeting requires a physical room, select an available meeting room using the “Add Location” option.
- **Booking Rooms:** We have listed both the Karur admin office and Rathinam branch office rooms. Please select your preferred room based on seating capacity and availability for the meeting.

You can choose multiple rooms in the same city or different cities for the same meeting if needed.

If you think your meeting might run over time, you can extend the room booking during your meeting if the room is available after your current booking ends. However, if the room is already booked for the next time slot, you will not be able to extend the booking.

Please leave the meeting room once your booking time has ended to allow others to use the room for their scheduled meetings.

For room booking, more features are available in the Outlook calendar compared to Teams calendar. You can also refer to the **Meeting Room Booking Guide** in the guides folder (Link: [Guides](#)) to book a room in the Outlook calendar.